

Deutsche Bank
Research

Q3 Earnings Review – Beating a high bar

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IMPORTANT RESEARCH DISCLOSURES AND ANALYST CERTIFICATIONS LOCATED IN APPENDIX 1. Deutsche Bank does and seeks to do business with companies covered in its research reports. Thus, investors should be aware that the firm may have a conflict of interest that could affect the objectivity of this report. Investors should consider this report as only a single factor in making their investment decision.

Key takeaways

At 75% through the STOXX 600 Q3 earnings season, sales, earnings, beats and guidance adjustments have been strong. Earnings growth stands at 27%, beating consensus by 8% and our own forecast by 3%.

Q3 earnings, sales & margins:

- Q3 earnings beat consensus estimates by 8% - the strongest result since Q1-24 and well above the 4% long-term average and our optimistic 5% forecast. The strength was broad-based, with two-thirds of companies exceeding expectations. Despite forecasts of a slowdown from Q2, earnings rose 3% quarter on quarter and 27% year on year. Excluding Energy, growth eased slightly but remained well in the double digits at 12%.
- At the sector level, Energy was the main positive contributor, as expected: earnings more than doubled year on year and beat estimates by 11%. Banks' earnings growth remained strong at 12%, but the beat rate decelerated to 3%. Technology earnings increased 78% year on year, exceeding consensus by 20%.
- Only Industrials and Autos missed expectations. Industrials still delivered solid growth (13%), while Autos again recorded the weakest earnings performance (-49%). Market reactions were volatile, with reactions to both misses and beats unusually strong. Banks and Construction experienced negative net price reactions despite beating estimates, whereas Autos and Real Estate reacted most positively, reflecting weak investor positioning.
- Sales were broadly in line with expectations, rising 12% year on year, supported by higher inflation. Growth was positive across all sectors except Autos and was strongest in Energy and Technology. Resilient demand and strong pricing power pushed margins to a new high at 13.5%, with significant gains both within and outside Energy compared with Q2.

Q3 Summary statistics (blended)

	Earnings Growth		Sales Growth	
	yoy	qoq	yoy	qoq
STOXX 600	27%	3%	12%	1%
ex Energy	12%	-2%	7%	0%
ex Banks	35%	9%	12%	1%

	Earnings Surprise		Sales Surprise	
	%	# beats	%	# beats
STOXX 600	8%	66%	0%	61%

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Key takeaways

Company guidance:

- Q3 was another strong quarter for corporate guidance. Although the upgrade ratio eased from Q2's exceptionally high level, upgrades (35%) still significantly outnumbered downgrades (11%), producing the second-highest ratio since at least Q1-24. For the first time, we also evaluate the reasons behind guidance changes. While downgrades were mainly company-specific or event-driven, strong demand and revenue momentum dominated upgrades, pointing to a healthy environment for most European corporates and a resilient macroeconomic backdrop despite geopolitical uncertainty. At the sector level, Technology recorded the highest guidance upgrade ratio, followed by Energy. The consumer space was bifurcated: Consumer Products, Retail and Staples saw net upgrades, while Travel, Media and Autos saw net downgrades.

Speech analysis:

- Using several AI models, we analyse STOXX 600 earnings call transcripts for the top companies in each European sector. Overall, the earnings picture remains resilient: AI and data-centre investment remains a clear source of strength, US demand is generally resilient, and early signs of recovery are emerging in the European industrial cycle. China weakness remains a headwind, especially in the consumer space.
- Companies were most confident in semiconductors and AI infrastructure, followed by Banks and Utilities. Semiconductor equipment, data-centre infrastructure and power grids are benefiting from structural investment, while Financials continue to benefit from low credit losses, strong capital generation and disciplined pricing. At the bottom end, company management was least confident in Consumer Discretionary, Autos and Chemicals.
- Pricing power remained intact, but increasingly selective. Companies with differentiated products, strong brands or regulated assets remained confident, while more commoditised business are starting to face volume sacrifices. Cash conversion began to show some signs of weakness, as several companies mentioned that inventory buffers are absorbing working capital and that capacity expansion is on the rise. So far, this has not put pressure on shareholder returns (see slide 19).

Revisions & outlook:

- Full-year earnings estimates continue to rise, increasing 1% (ex-Energy) since the end of the previous earnings season, for both FY26 and FY27. After Energy, Technology and Telcos have driven the strongest recent upgrades, while Autos continue to face sharp downgrades. Staples remains the healthiest consumer sector in terms of earnings forecast revisions.
- Current estimates imply full-year earnings growth of 17% (10% excluding Energy), with growth expected to accelerate further in Q4. This year, companies have benefited from substantial energy-cost hedging, strong pricing power, resilient demand and tariff rebates. We expect the robust demand environment to continue supporting earnings into 2027, offsetting expiring energy cost hedges, which might start to bite on the cost side. Earnings in the Energy sector should start normalising again after extraordinary growth in 2026. For next year, we forecast 14% earnings growth ex Energy and 10% including Energy for the STOXX 600, roughly in line with consensus. Ex-Energy, this implies an acceleration in growth from 10% in this year to 14%, driven by broad-based strength across sectors.

Europe vs USA:

- Although European earnings growth accelerated again in Q3, it remained 7 pp below the US. S&P 500 earnings rose 34%, broadly in line with Q2, with Technology and Energy & Materials contributing three-quarters of the growth. Notably, the growth gap between Europe and the US narrowed considerably (from 10 pp in Q2). In addition, Europe delivered a stronger earnings beat than the US (8% vs 5%). However, the 2027 outlook still looks significantly stronger for the US, with S&P 500 earnings forecast to grow 19%, compared with 10% in Europe. For further details on US earnings, see: Asset Allocation: Q3 2026 Earnings Takes: Growth Holds In The 30s

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Agenda



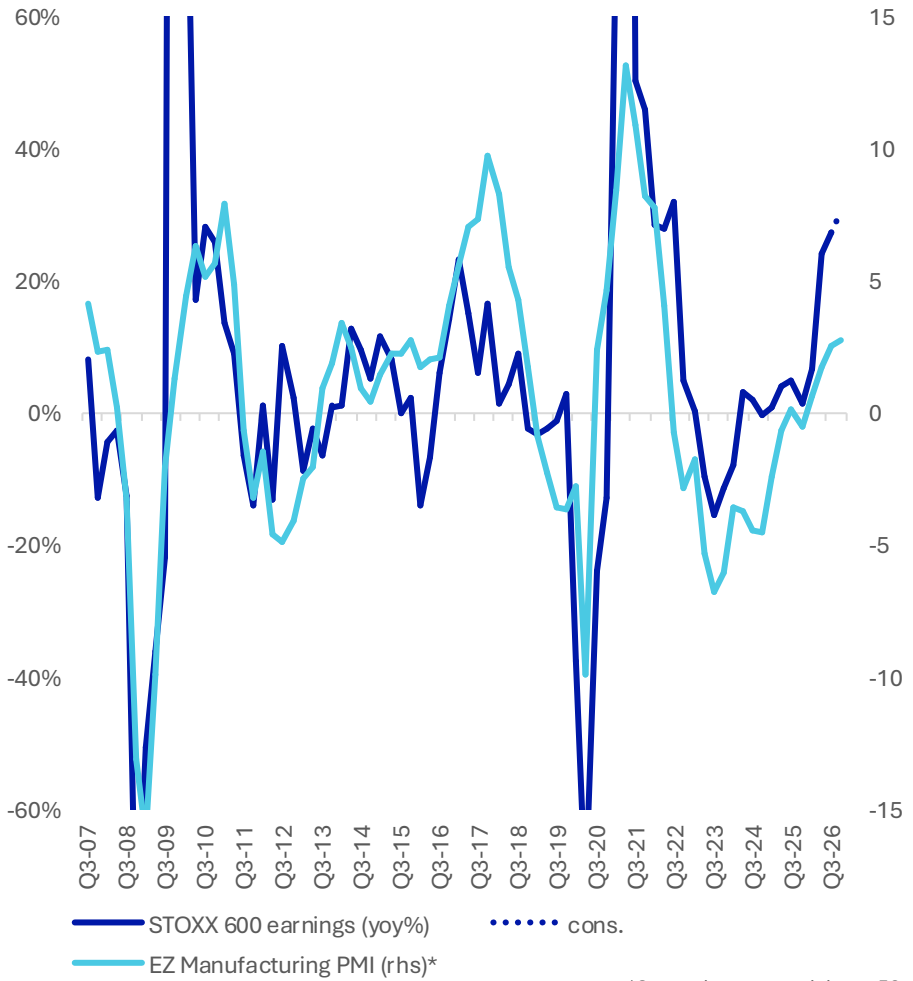
1	**Macro**		**p. 04**
2	**Earnings**		**p. 06**
	- Quarterly	p. 06	
	- Semi-annually	p. 08	
3	**Sales & Margins**		**p. 09**
4	**Surprise & Guidance**		**p. 11**
5	**Revisions**		**p. 15**
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8	**Shareholder return**		**p. 19**

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Macro: backdrop remains supportive

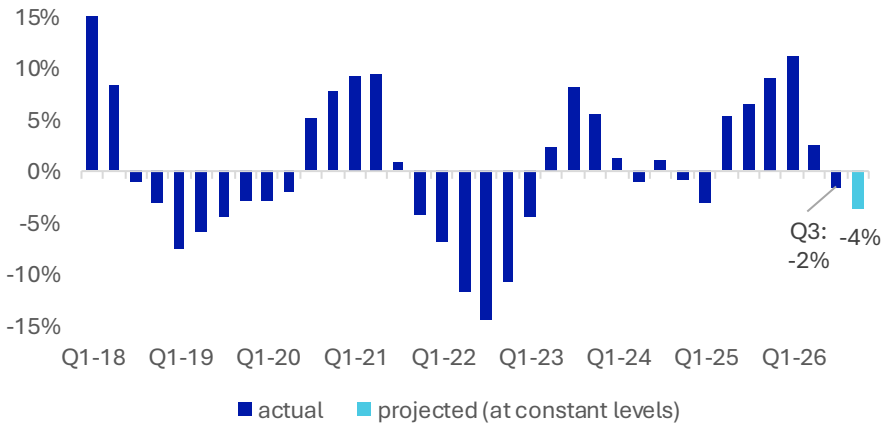
Earnings growth keeps outperforming strong Manufacturing PMIs, supported by (energy) inflation and FX tailwinds.

EZ Manufacturing PMIs vs earnings growth

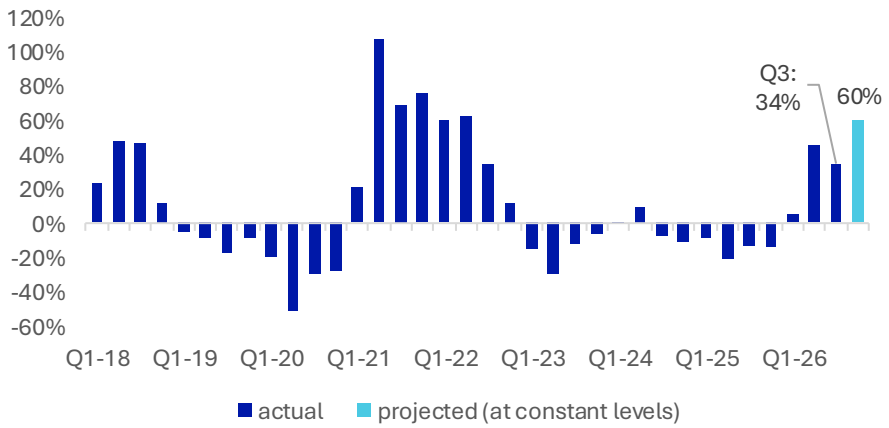


*3-month average, delta to 50

EUR/USD, yoy – turning into mild tailwind



Brent, yoy – supporting Energy earnings



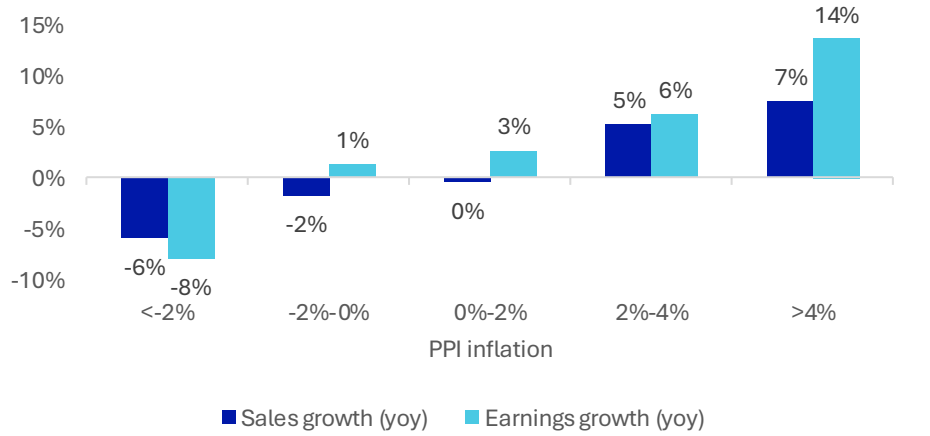
Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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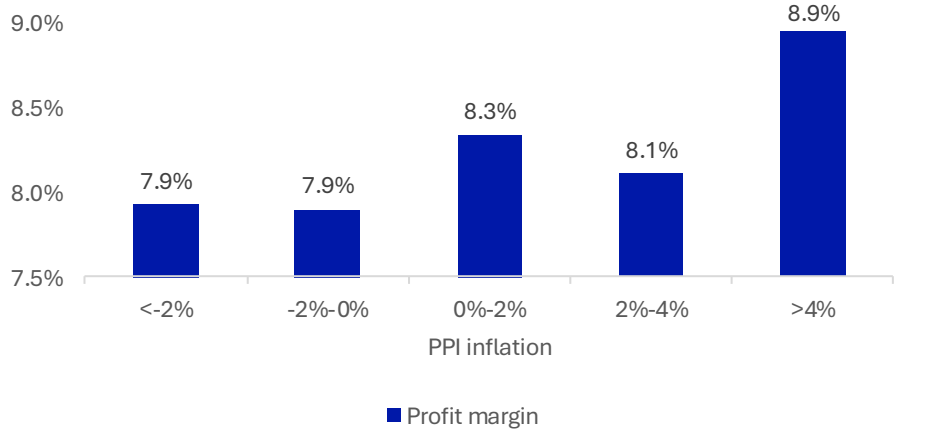
Macro: inflation boosts profits

Historically, higher inflation has not only resulted in stronger sales growth but also led to higher earnings growth and margins.

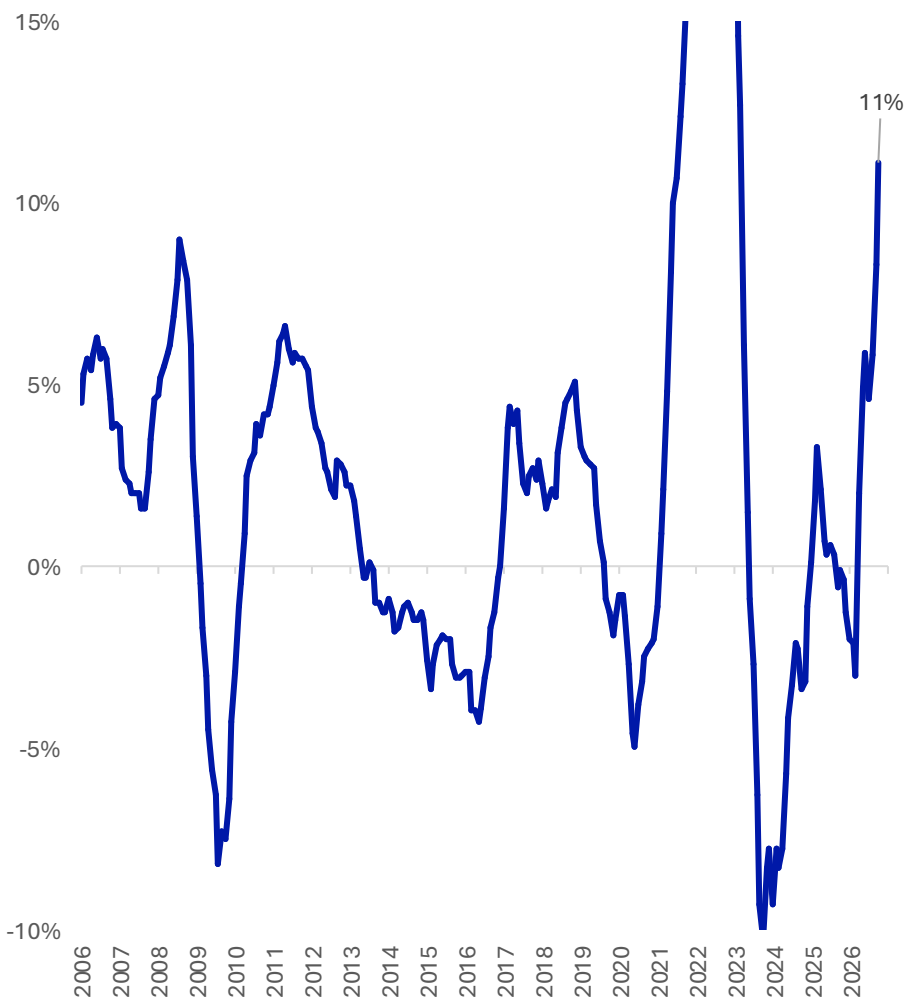
Inflation leads to stronger sales, earnings...



...and profit margins



EZ PPI inflation reached 11% in September



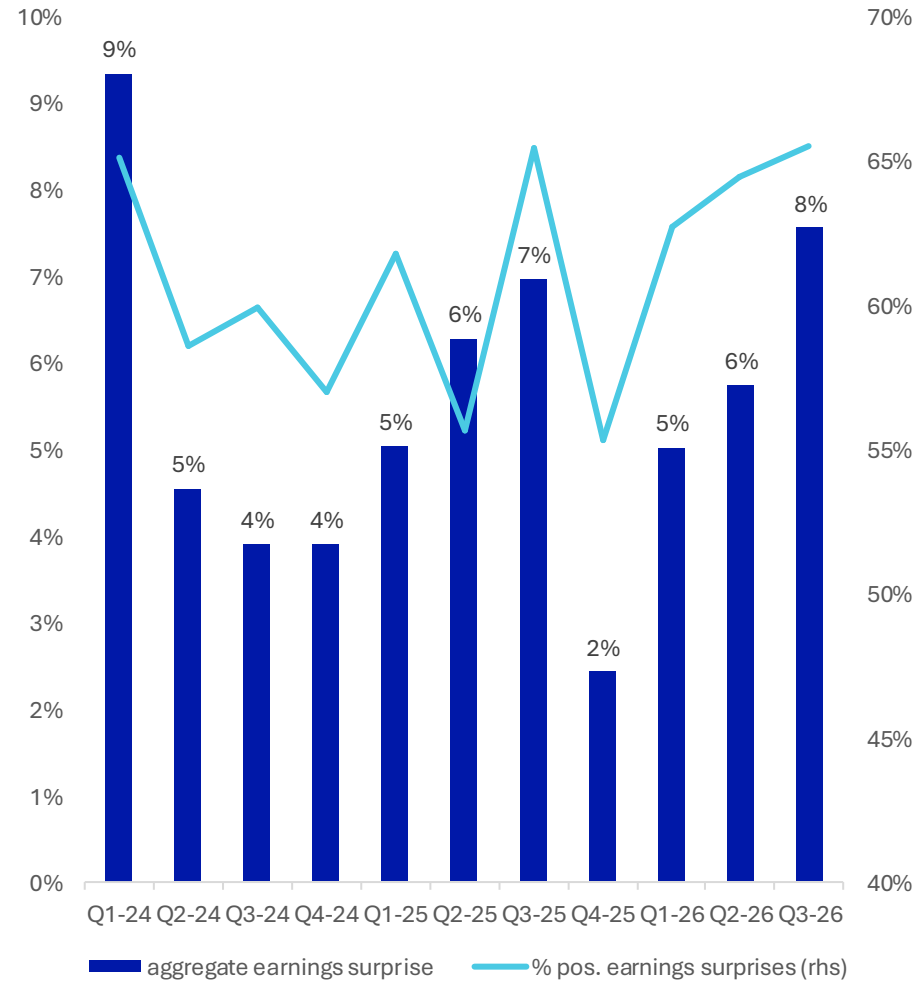
Time period: 2006-today, based on quarterly STOXX 600 earnings, sales, margins and PPI inflation. Median figures. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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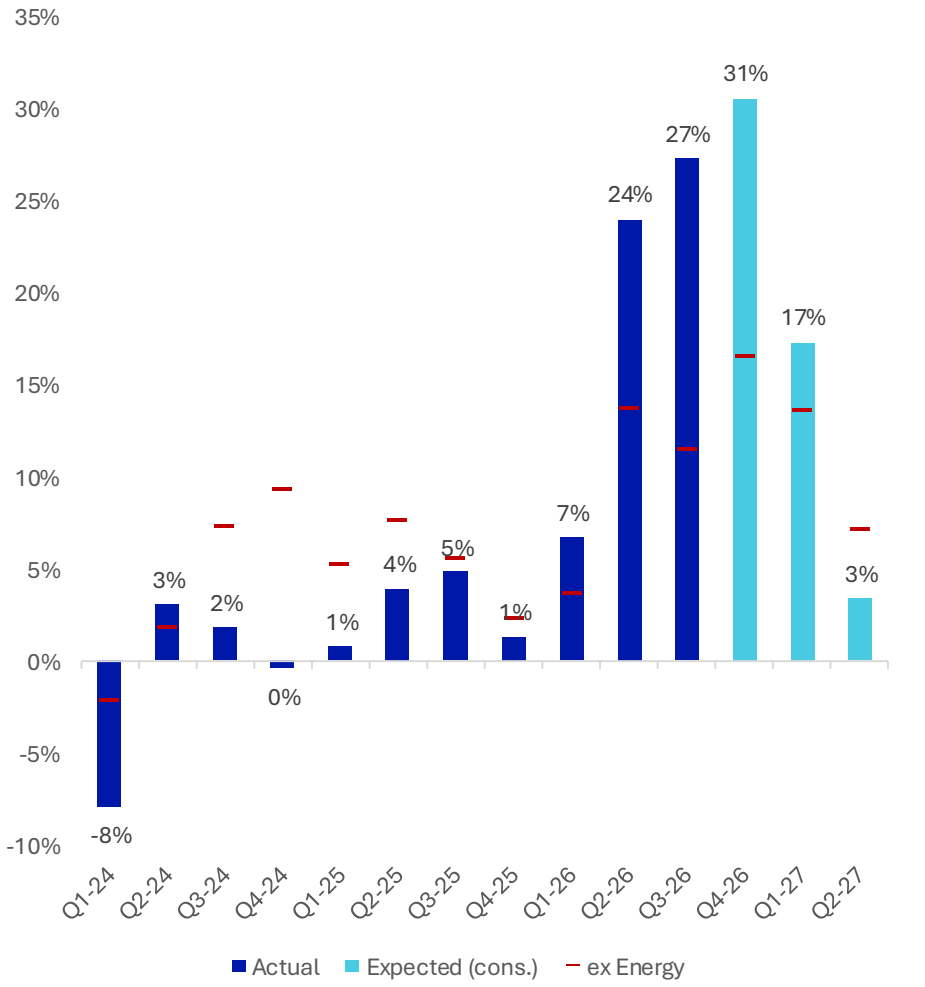
Quarterly earnings: overview

Earnings beats reached their highest level since Q1-24, and growth accelerated further after an already-strong Q2 season.

Above-average beats and breadth



Quarterly earnings and estimates (yoy)

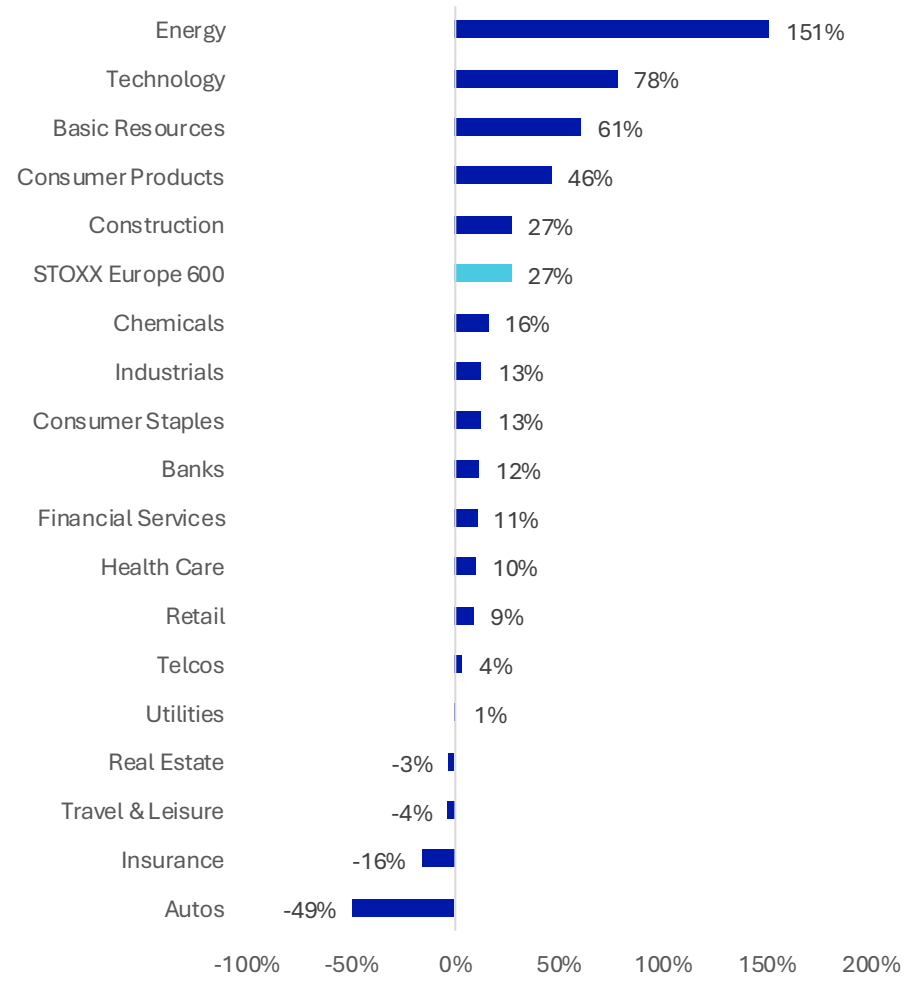


Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

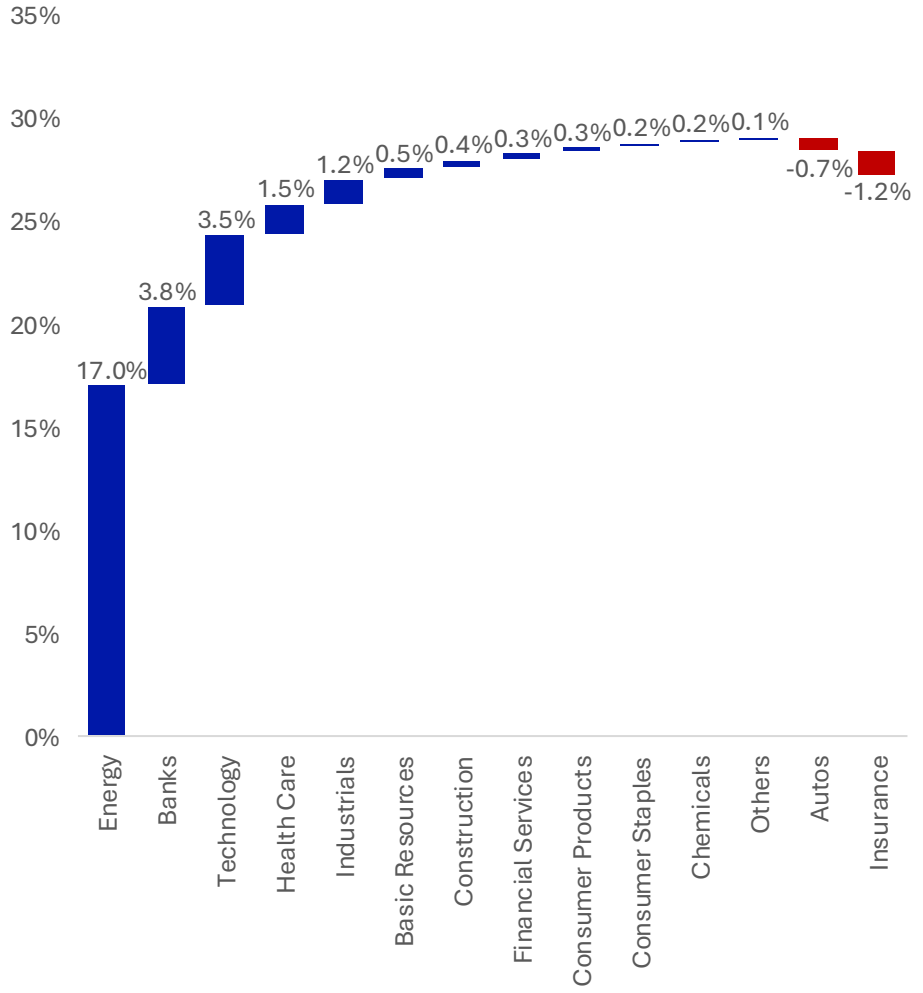
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Quarterly earnings: Energy the main driver, followed by Banks and Technology

Q3: Earnings growth (yoy)



Q3: Contribution to earnings growth (yoy)



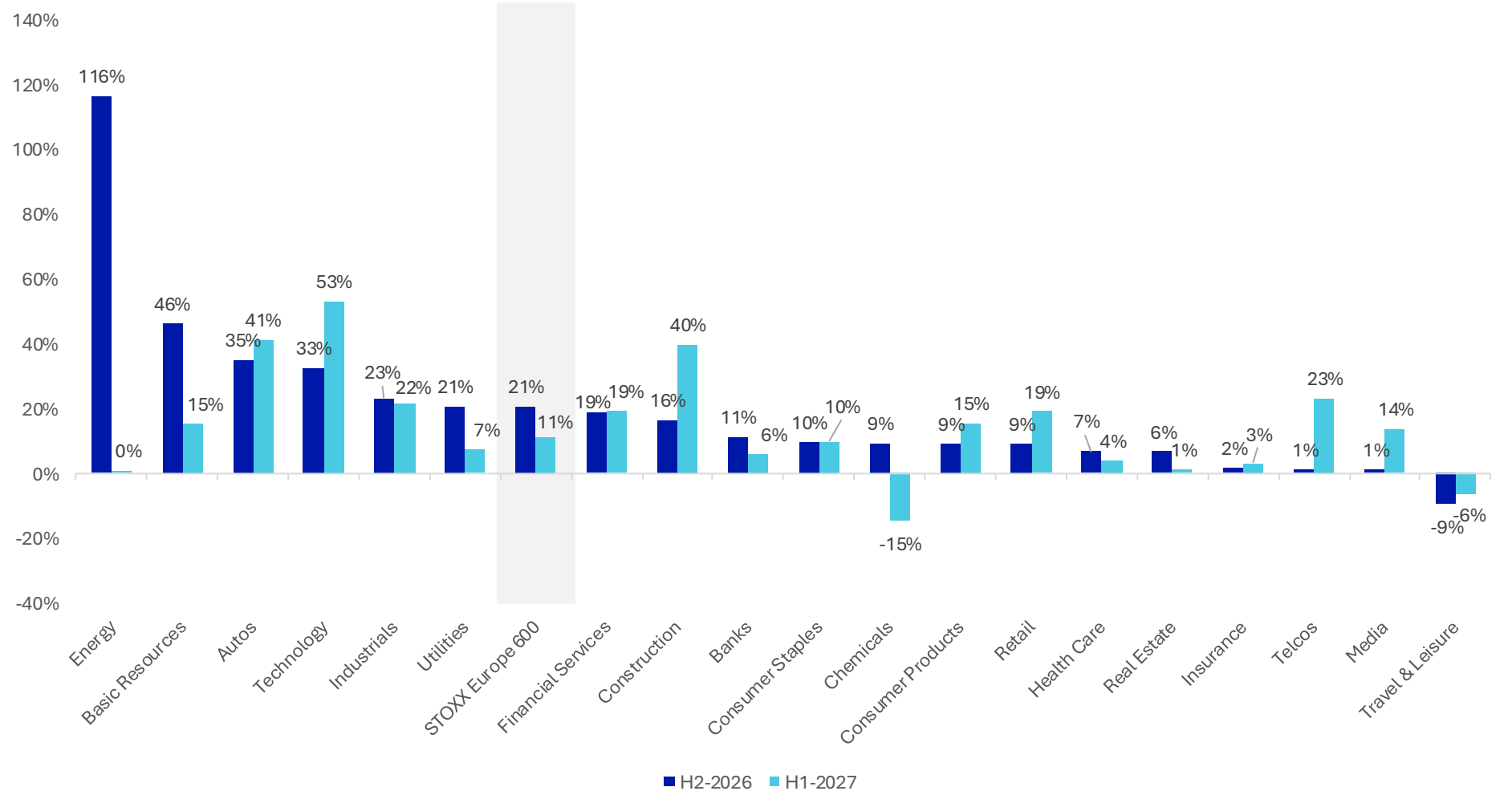
Note: Blended earnings growth. Left chart ex Media due to small sample size. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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Semi-annual earnings: sector view

Earnings growth to decelerate in H1-2027, mainly due to a normalization in Energy earnings growth.

Expected earnings growth by sector (yoy)



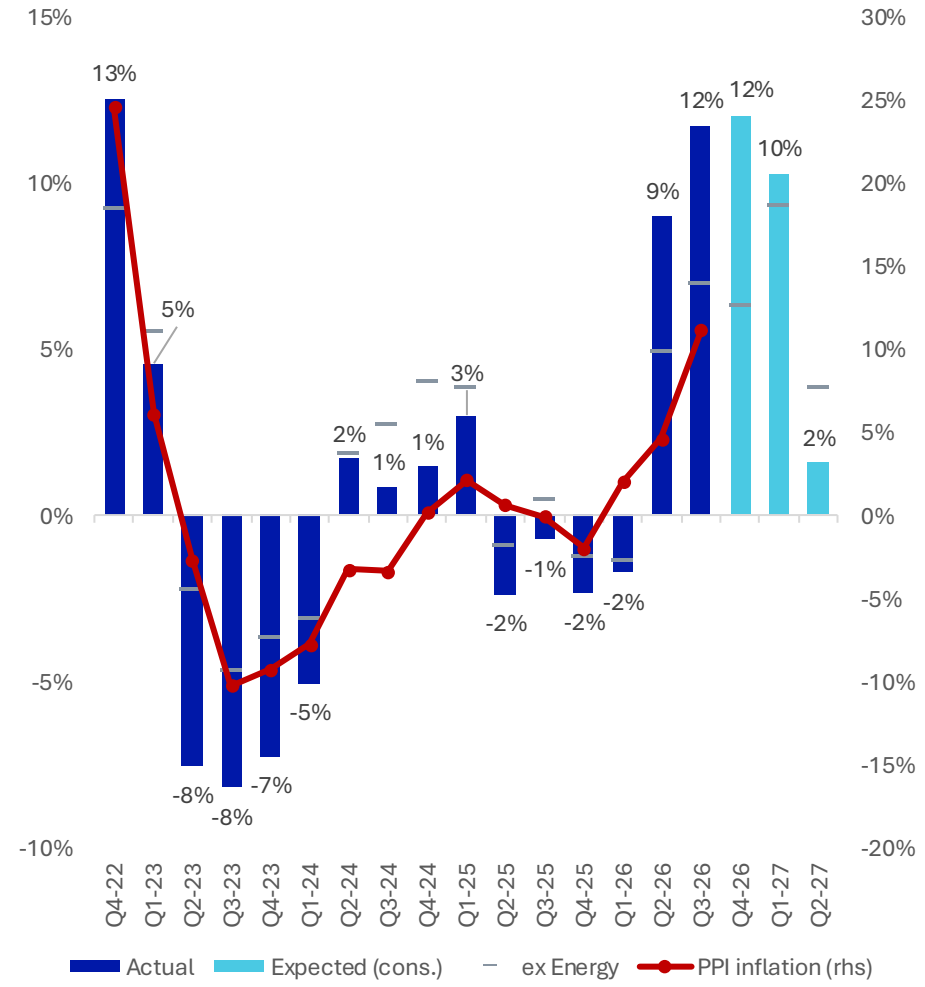
Note: Aggregate growth. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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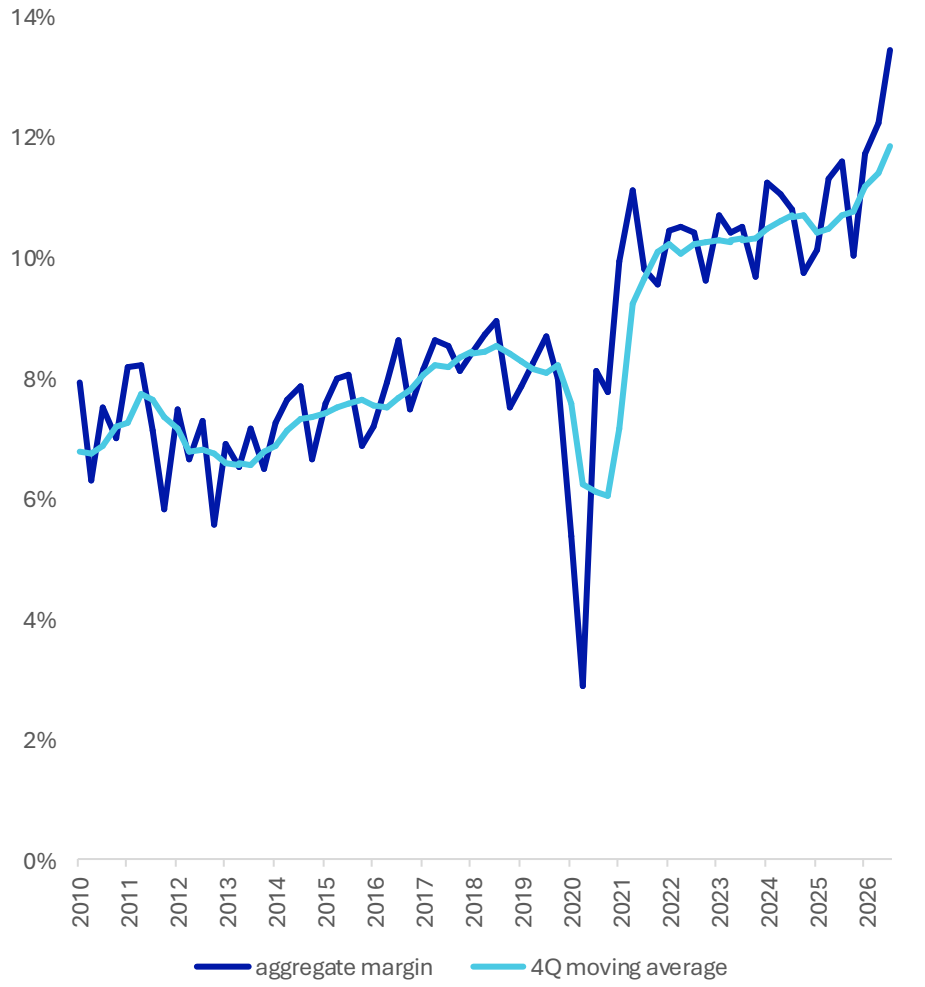
Quarterly sales & margins

Sales growth accelerated into the double digits in Q3. Margins continue to expand significantly, both incl. and excl. Energy.

Quarterly sales growth (yoy)



Profit margins

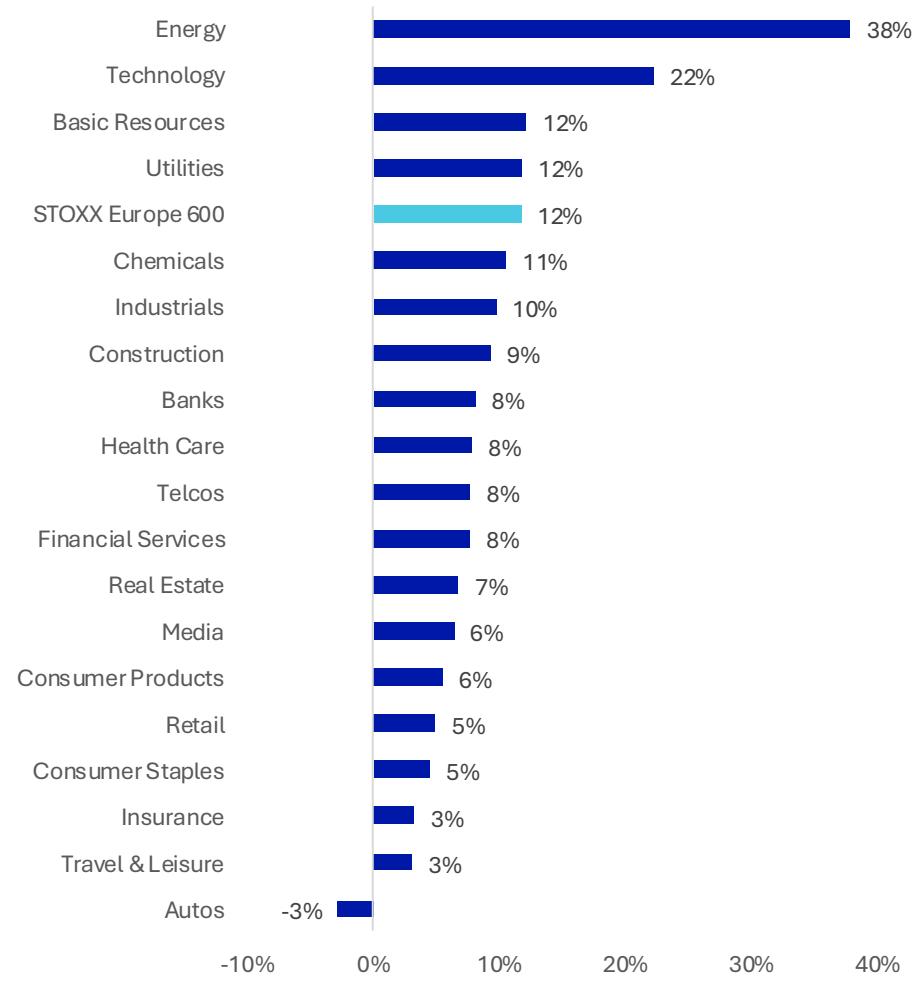


Note: Aggregate growth. Only including companies which report quarterly sales. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

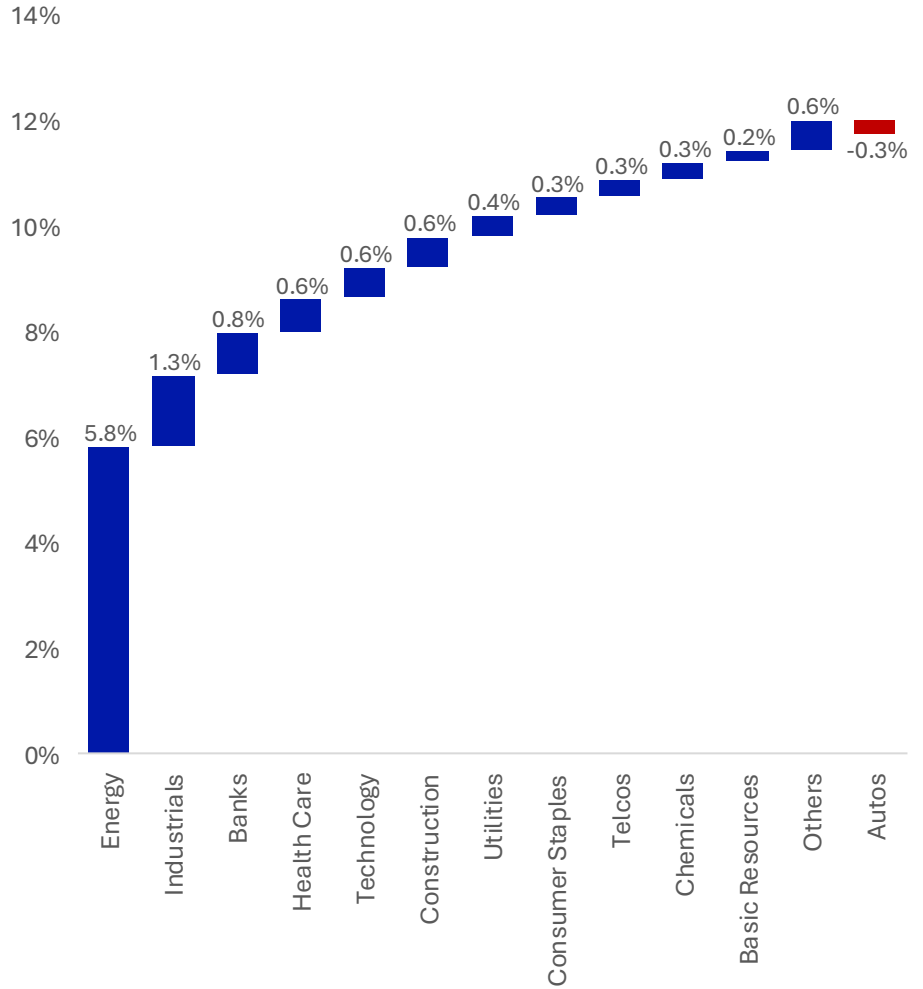
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Quarterly sales: Autos the only sector to record negative sales growth in Q3

Q3: Sales growth (yoy)



Q3: Contribution to sales growth (yoy)



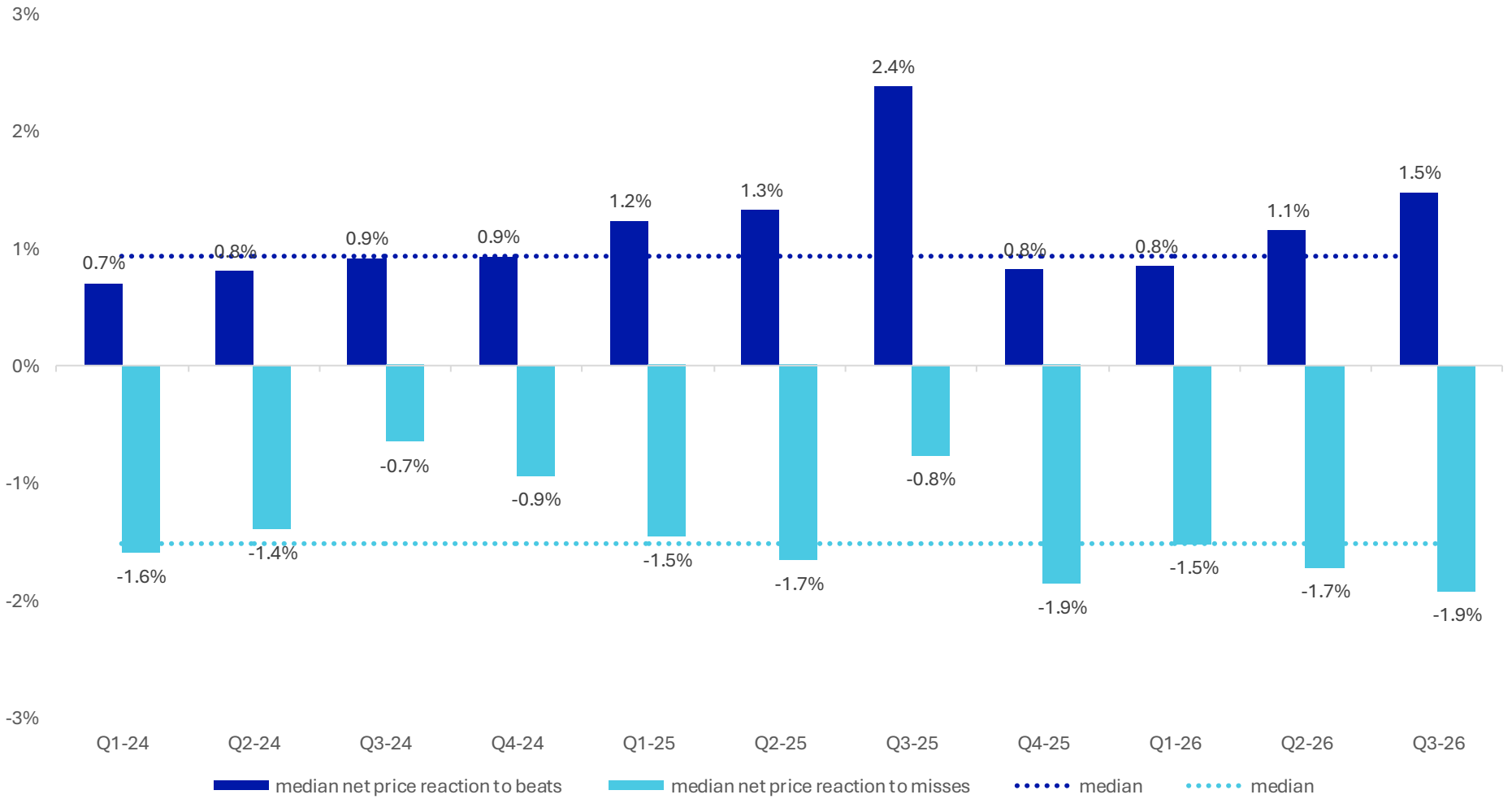
Note: Blended sales growth. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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Surprises vs price reactions

Price reactions to sales and earnings releases were slightly more extreme than usual this season.

Median net price reactions on day of reporting



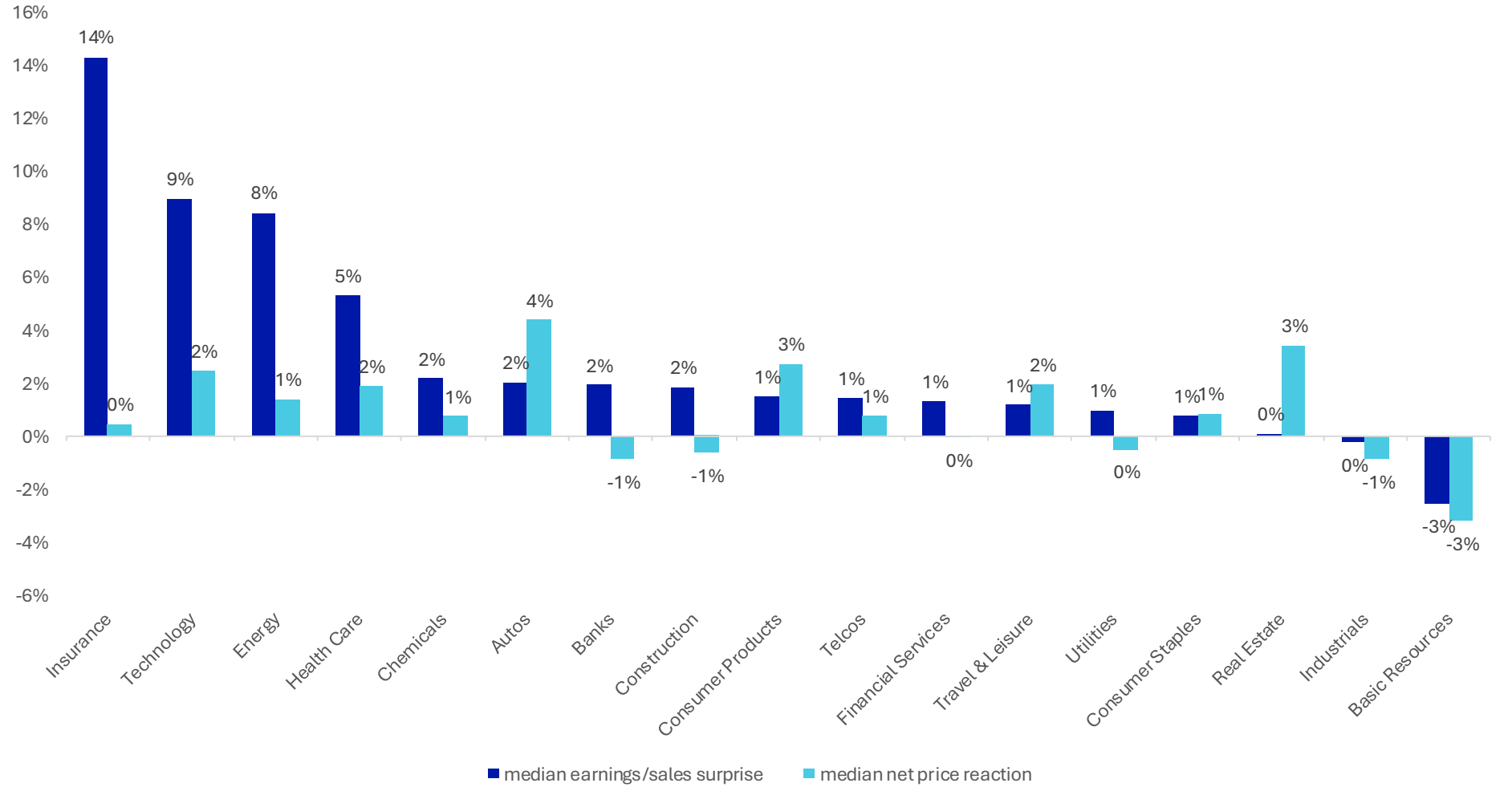
Note: net price reaction is the price reaction on reporting day net of STOXX Europe 600 performance. Surprises in both charts refer to both earnings and sales surprises. Excluding Retail, Media due to outliers. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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Surprises vs price reactions

Construction and Banks saw negative price reactions despite delivering beats. Autos and Real Estate reacted most positively, reflecting weak positioning in both sectors.

Sectoral price reactions to earnings and sales surprises



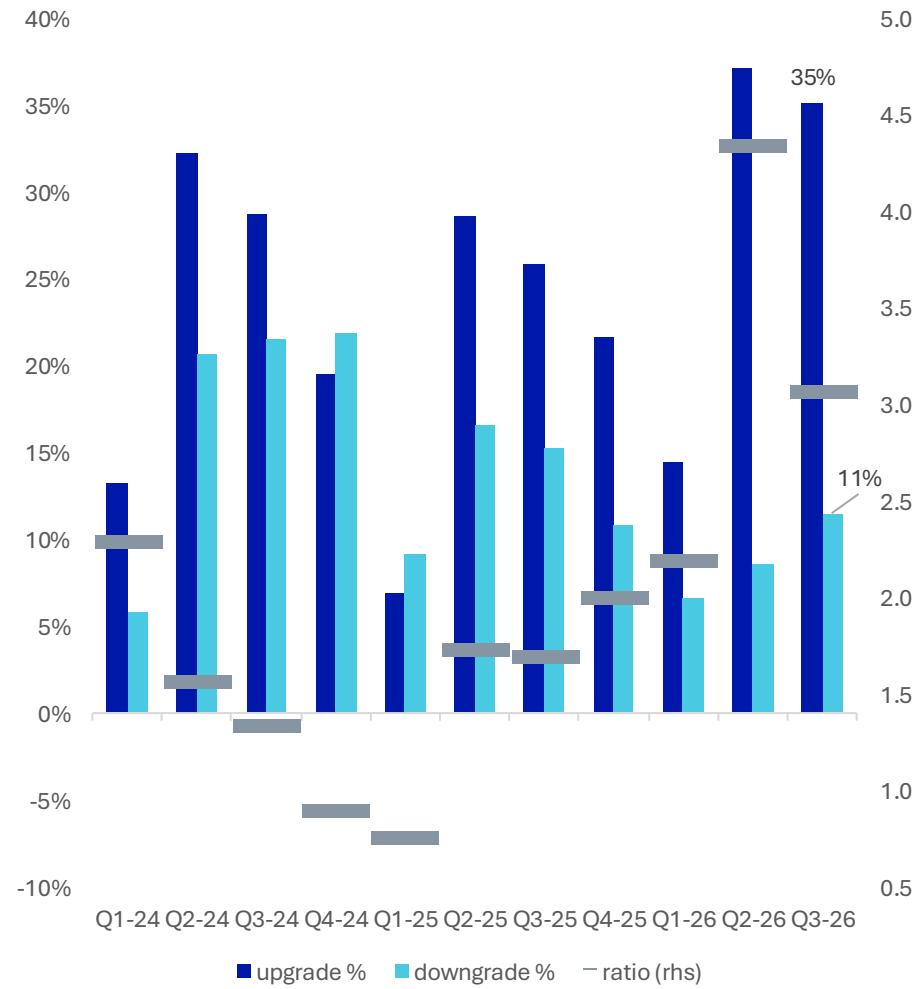
Note: net price reaction is the price reaction on reporting day net of STOXX Europe 600 performance. Surprises refer to both earnings and sales surprises. Excluding Retail, Media due to small number of companies. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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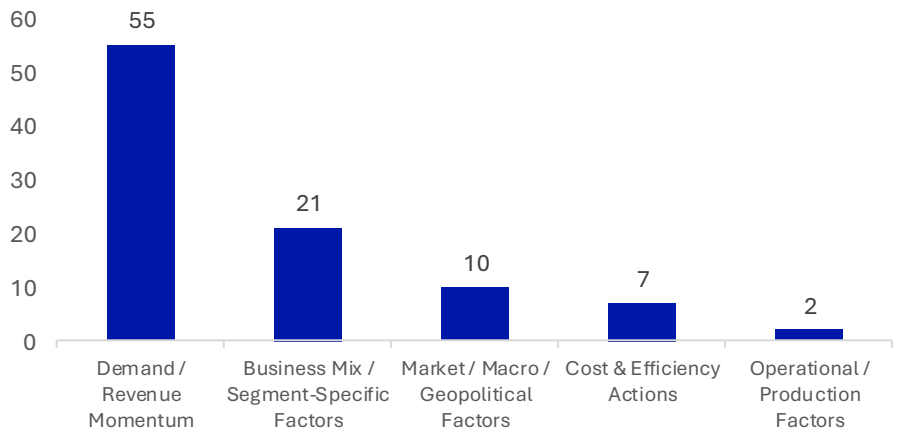
Company guidance

More than a third of companies upgraded guidance in Q3, mainly due to strong demand.

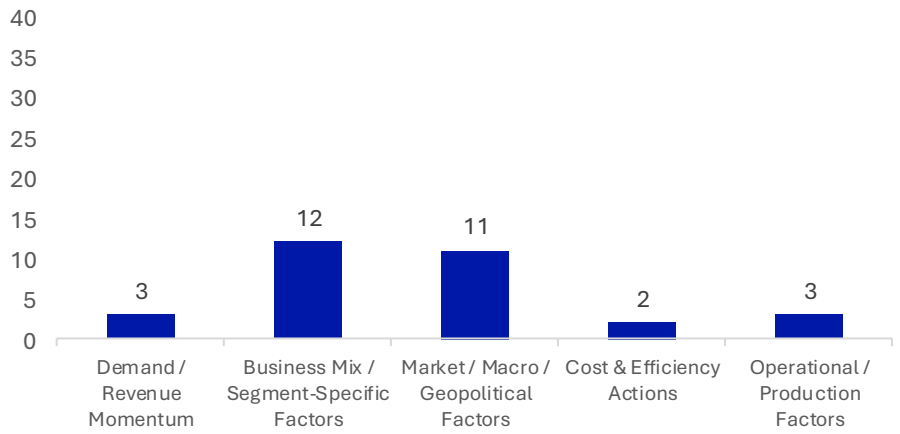
Upgrade ratio



Main reasons for guidance upgrades



Main reasons for guidance downgrades



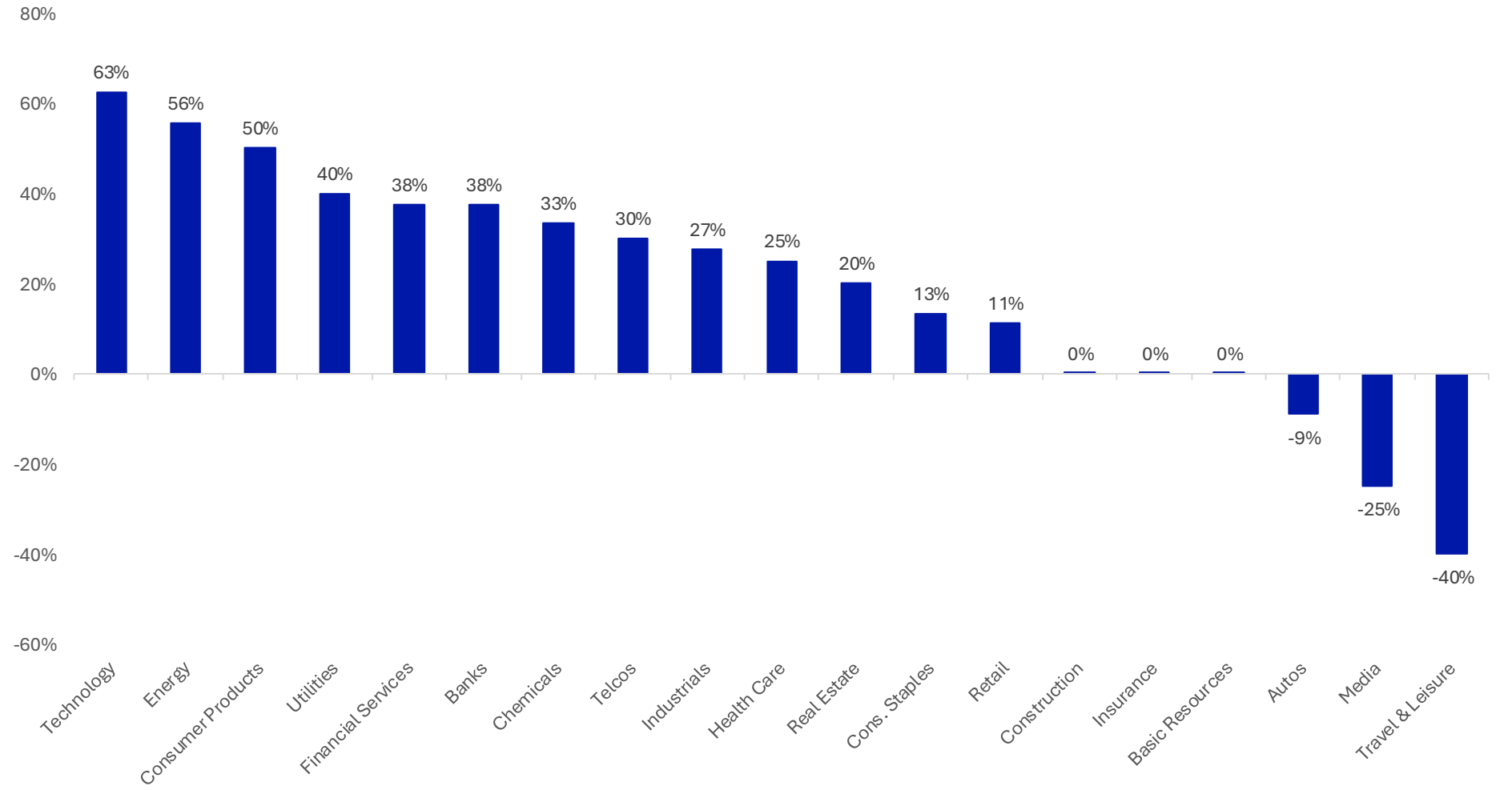
Note: net price reaction is the price reaction on reporting day net of STOXX Europe 600 performance. N=270 for company guidance.
Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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Ratio of guidance upgrades

Technology and Energy saw the strongest guidance upgrade ratios this quarter, while some Consumer Discretionary segments remain under pressure.

Guidance upgrades minus downgrades divided by total



N=270. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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Revisions: ex-Energy earnings forecasts raised 1% since last earnings season

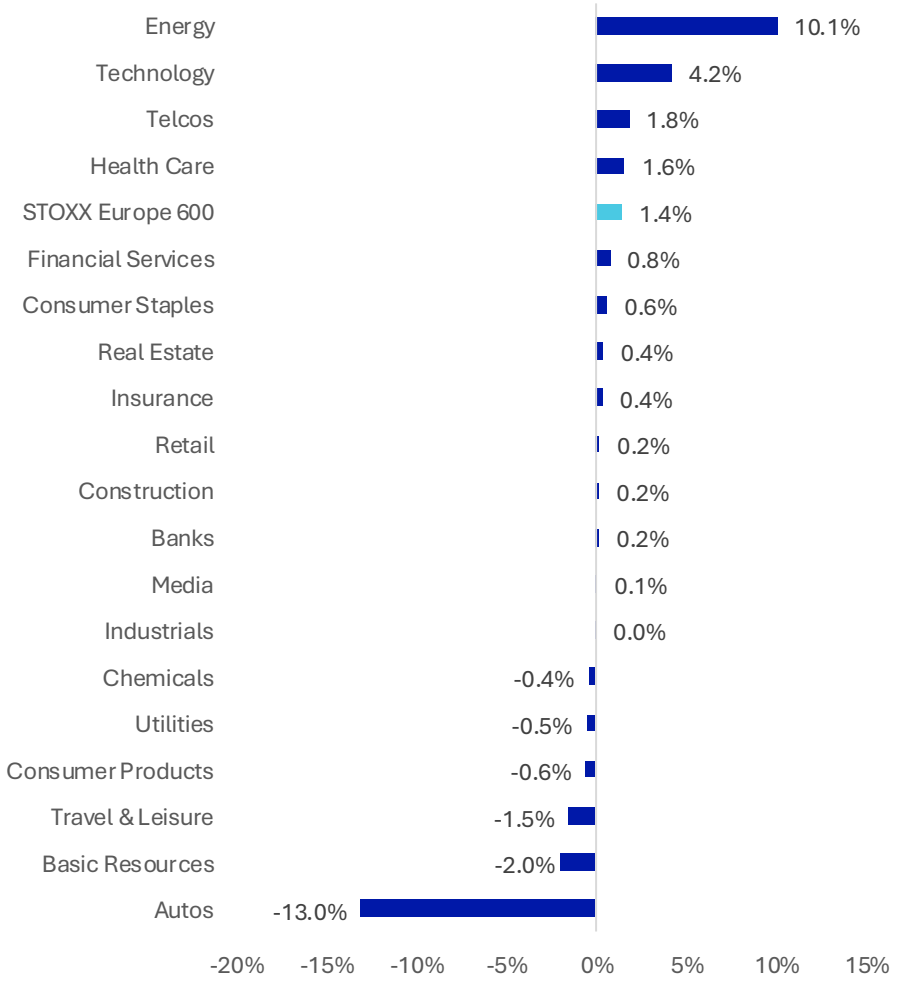
FY26 earnings forecast revisions



FY27 earnings forecast revisions



FY26 earnings forecast revisions (1m)

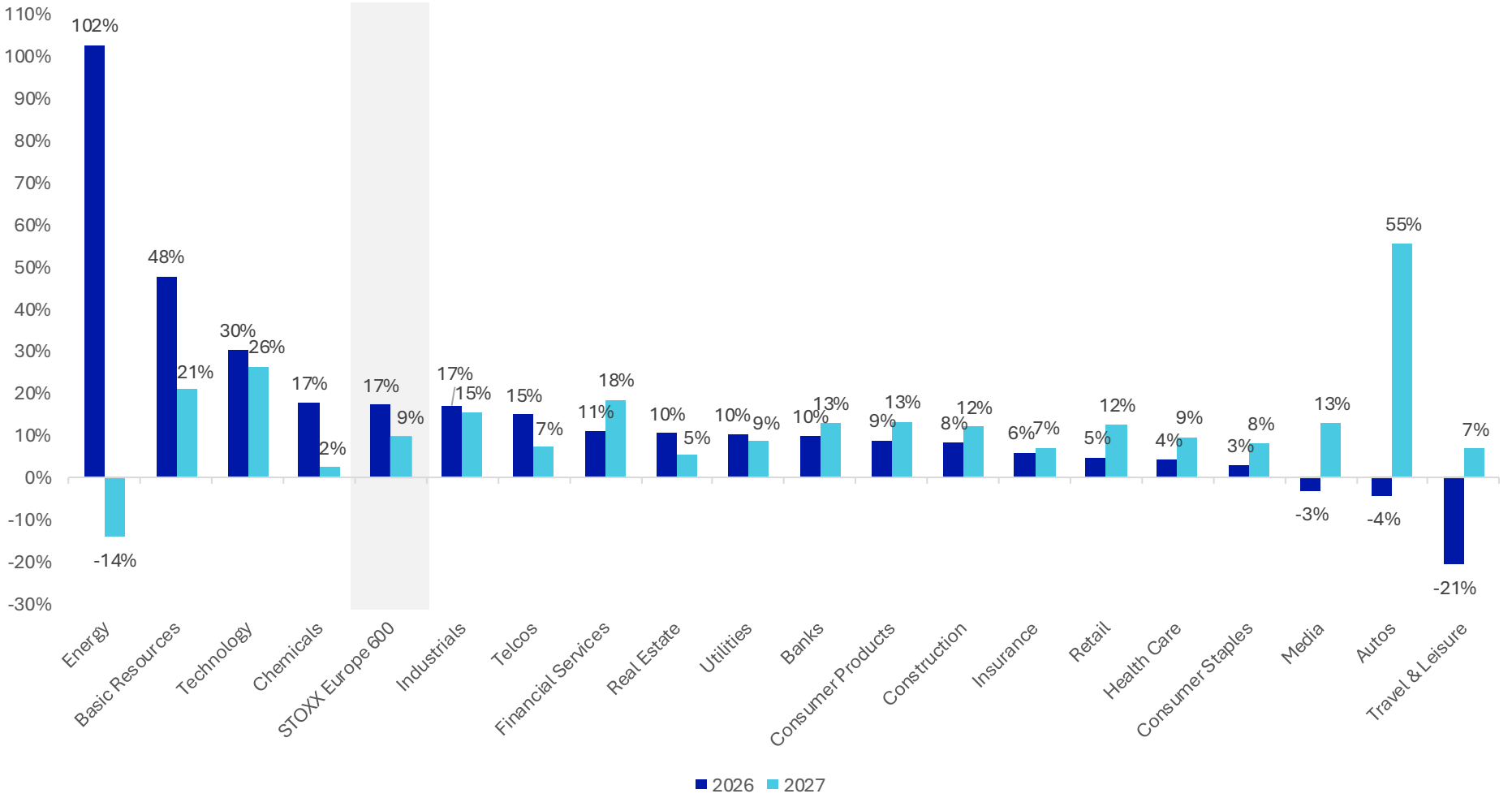


Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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FY earnings: Earnings growth to decelerate in 2027 due to weaker Energy earnings

STOXX 600 (blended) aggregate earnings growth by sector (cons.)

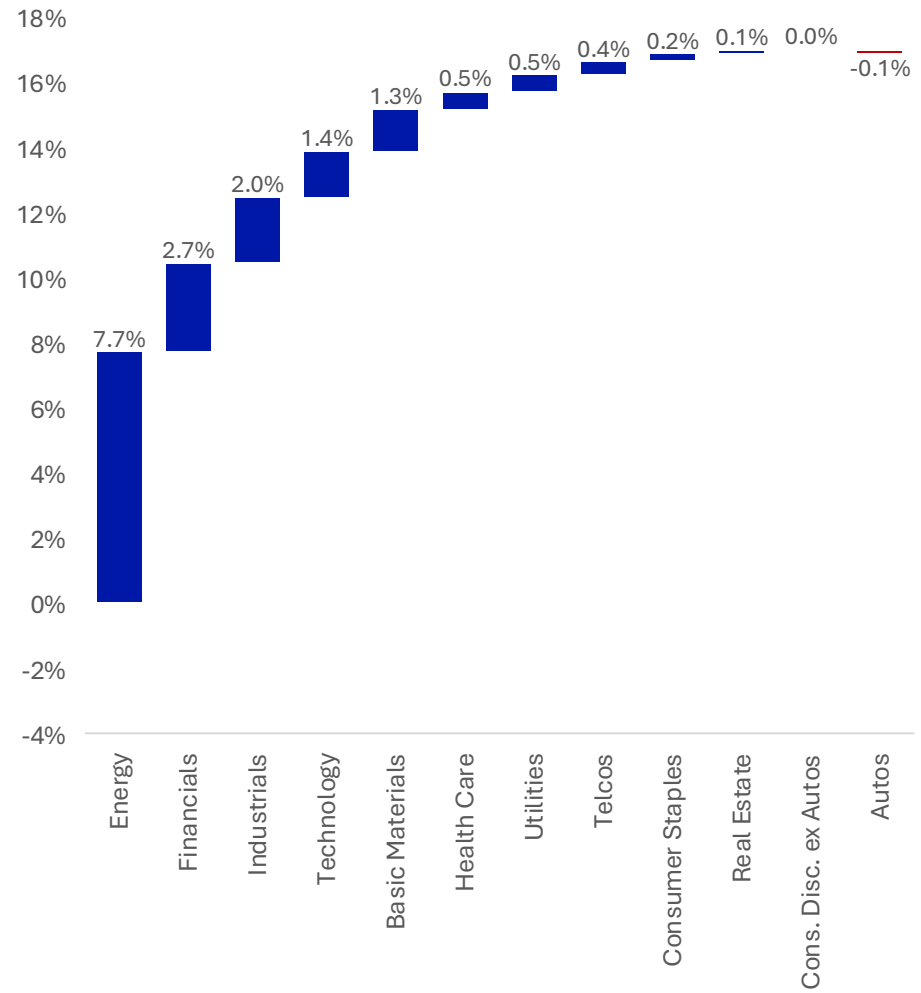


Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

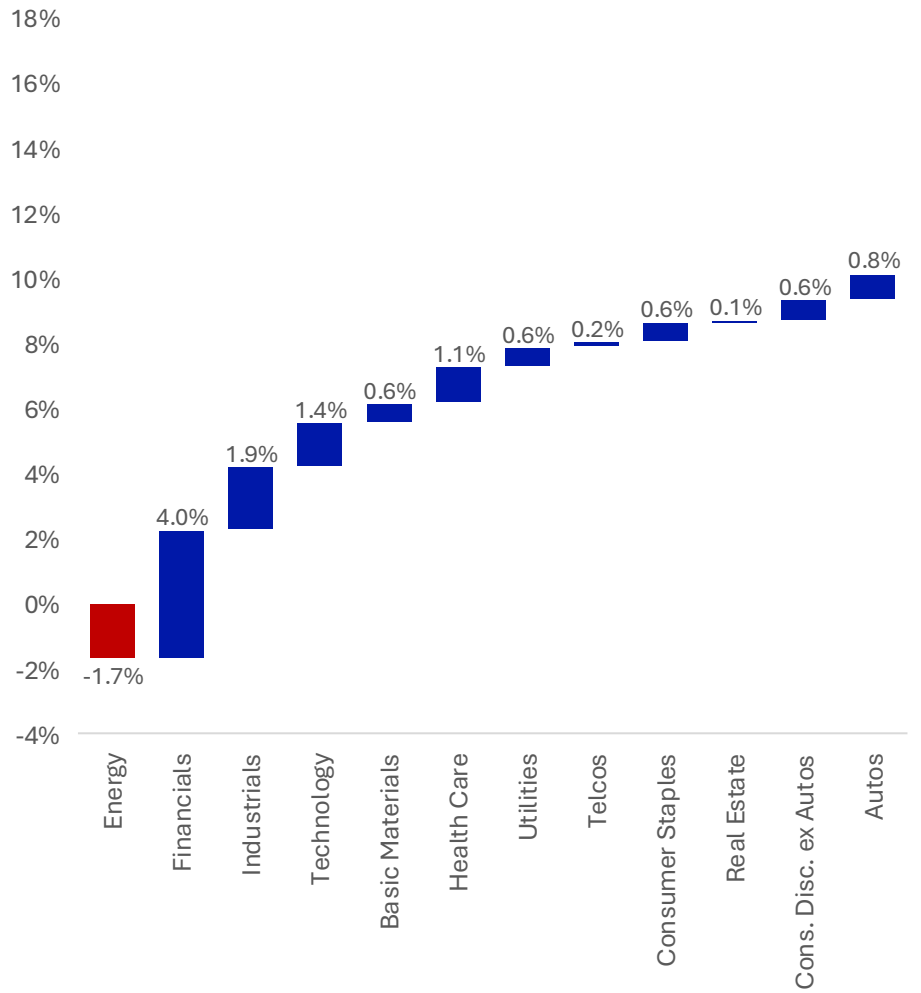
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FY earnings: 2027 to see broad-based growth at 10% (14% ex Energy)

FY26 earnings growth contributions (cons.)



FY27 earnings growth contributions (DBe)



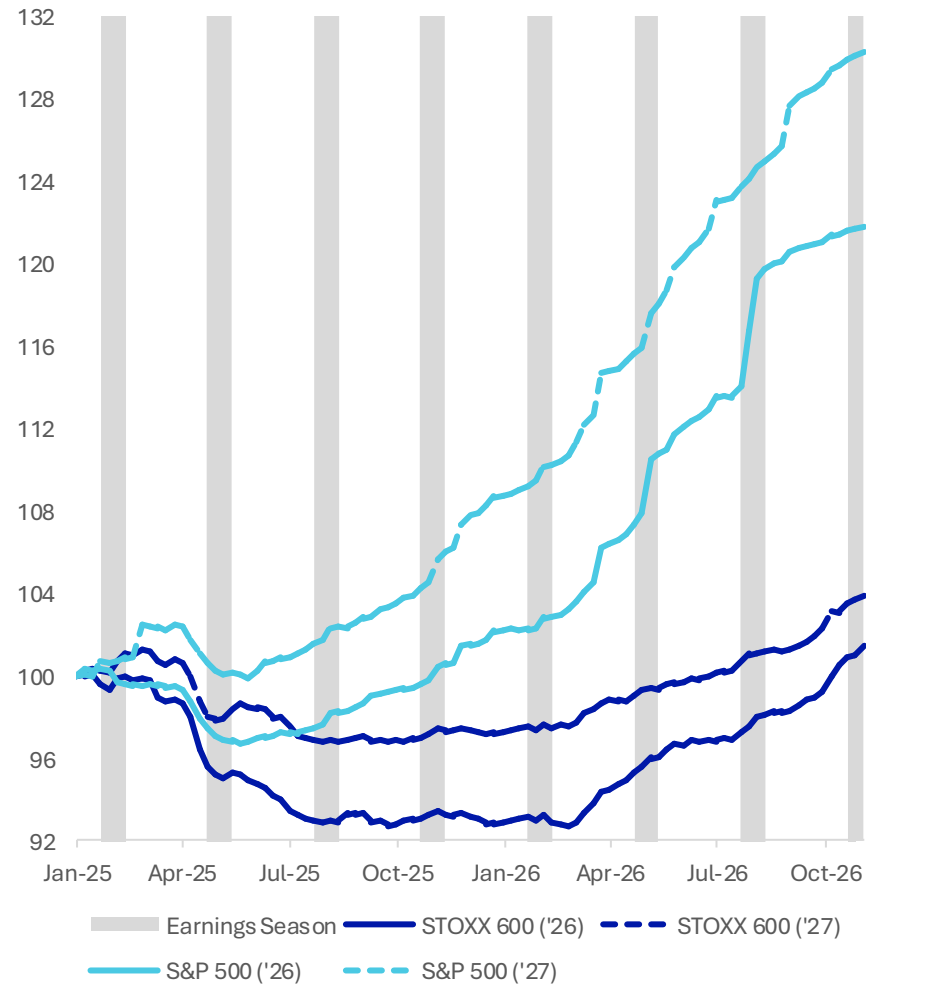
Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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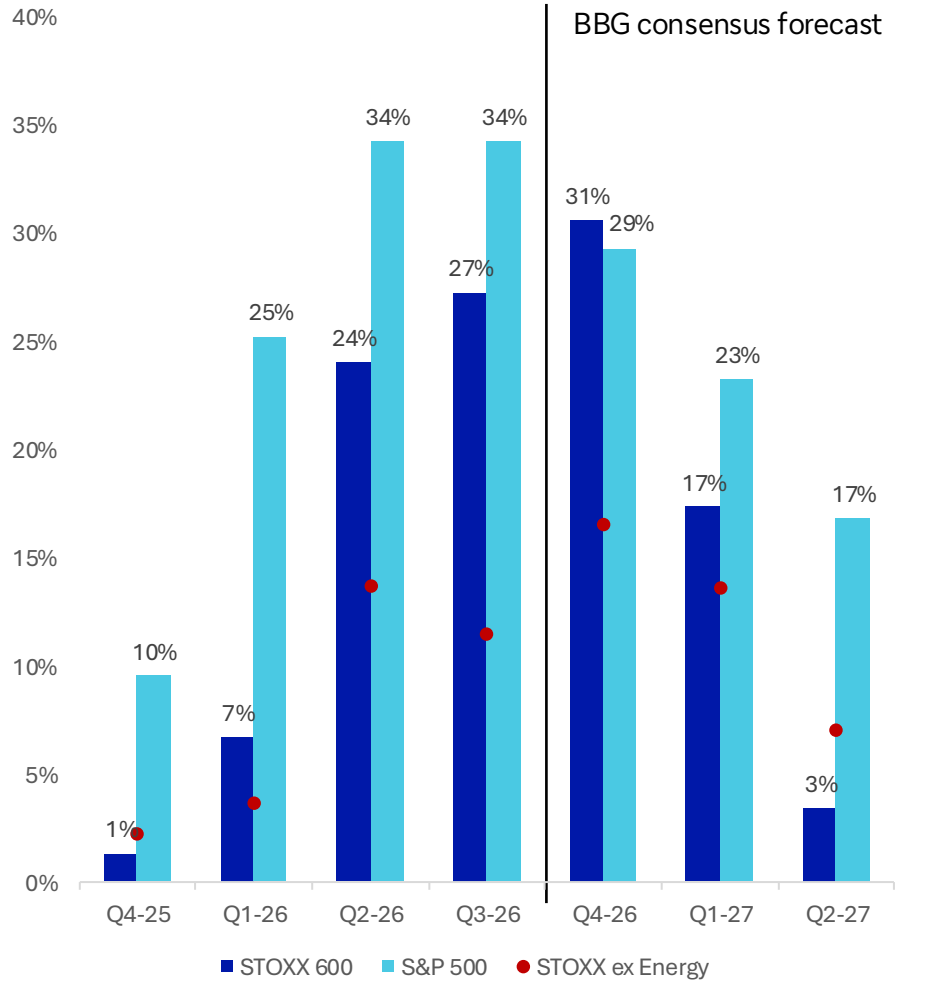
Europe vs USA

US earnings still outperform Europe, but the gap is narrowing.

FY earnings forecast revisions



Quarterly earnings growth* (yoy)

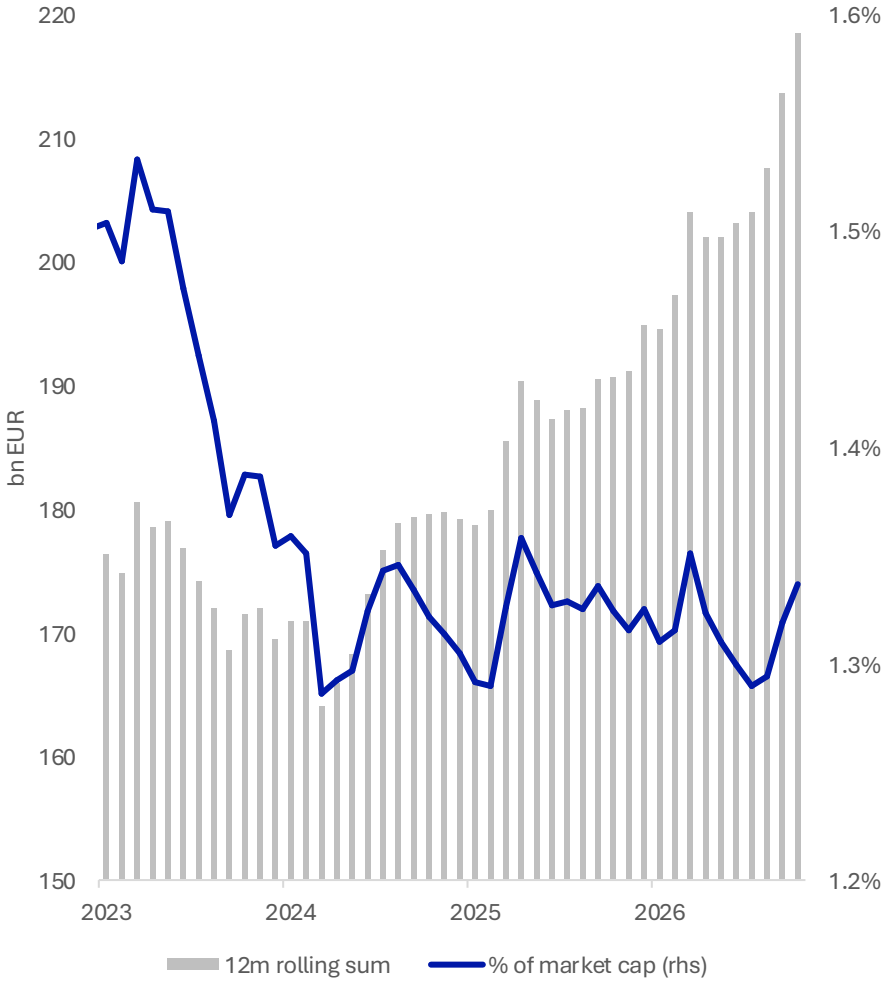


*US growth rates are adjusted by DB for special effects. Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

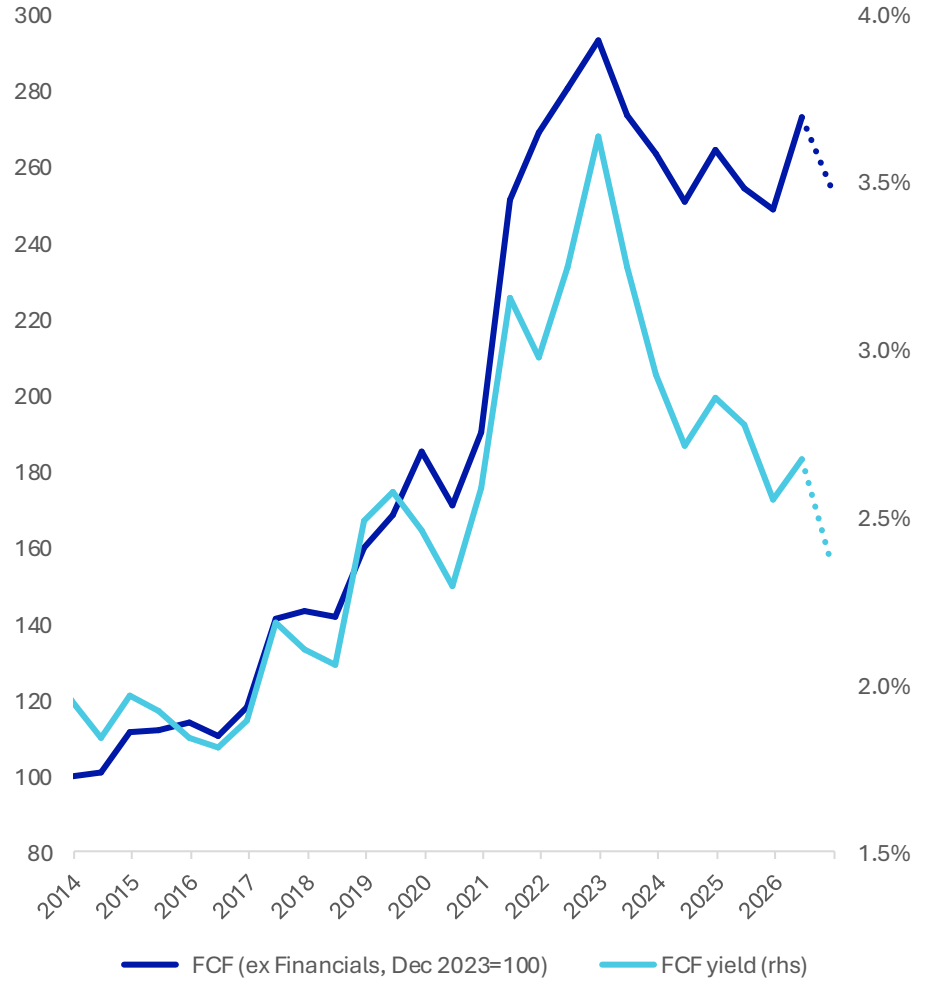
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Shareholder returns: Buybacks remain resilient, but FCF looks set to decline

Buybacks holding up well...



...but FCF is projected to decline

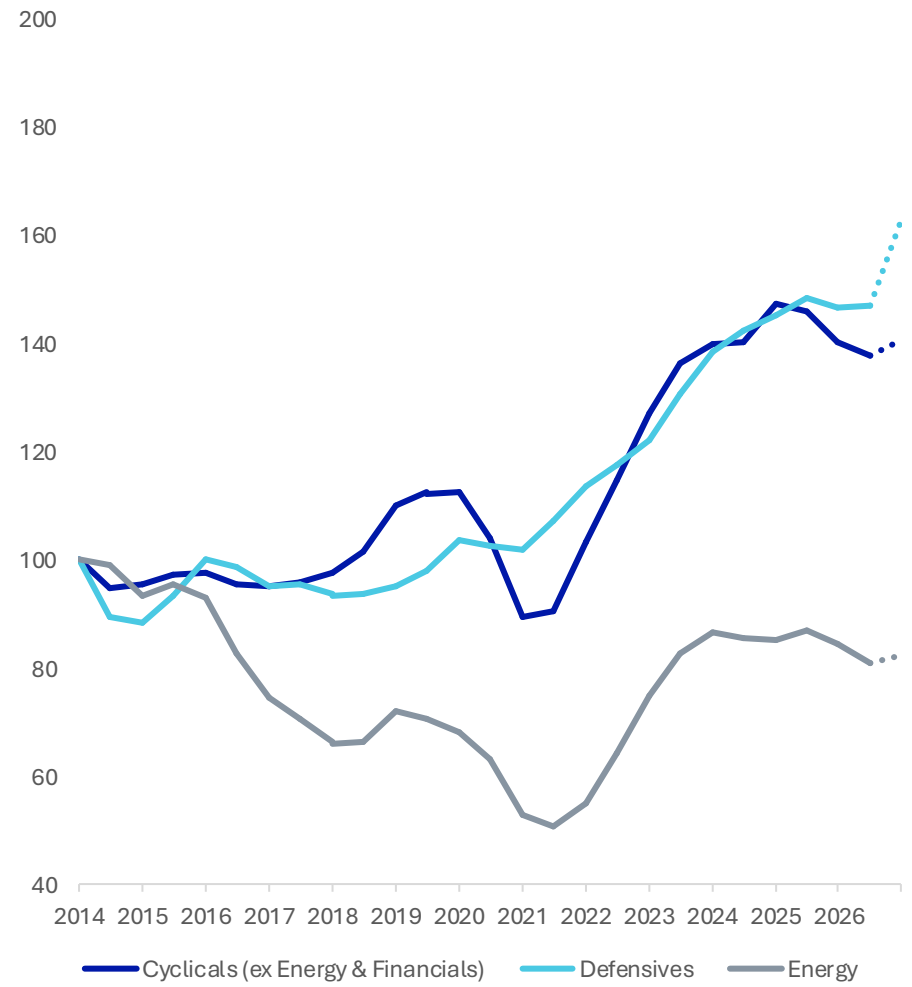


Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

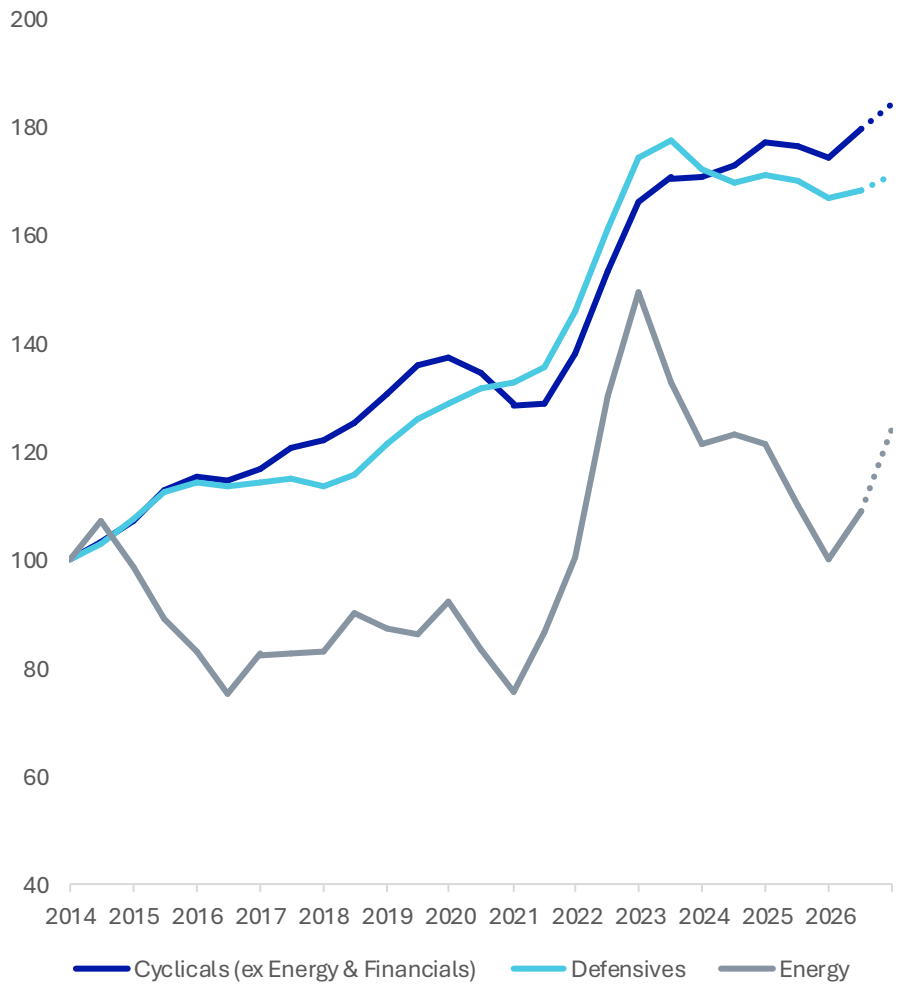
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Shareholder returns: Higher capex and inventories weigh on FCF

Capex looks set to rise (Dec 2023=100)



Inventories also trending higher (Dec 2023=100)



Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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Reporting calendar

Only showing STOXX 600 companies with >20 bn EUR market cap

Date	Ticker	Company	Sector	Market Cap (million EUR)
11/6/2026	AMS SQ Equity	AMADEUS IT GROUP SA	Technology	25,739
11/6/2026	BMPS IM Equity	BANCA MONTE DEI PASCHI SIENA	Financials	34,893
11/6/2026	DTG GY Equity	DAIMLER TRUCK HOLDING AG	Industrials	31,390
11/6/2026	EDP PL Equity	EDP SA	Utilities	20,836
11/6/2026	IAG LN Equity	INTL CONSOLIDATED AIRLINE-DI	Consumer Discretionary	22,698
11/9/2026	HNR1 GY Equity	HANNOVER RUECK SE	Financials	35,817
11/9/2026	UCG IM Equity	UNICREDIT SPA	Financials	118,103
11/10/2026	ALC SE Equity	ALCON INC	Health Care	34,445
11/10/2026	IFX GY Equity	INFINEON TECHNOLOGIES AG	Technology	66,171
11/10/2026	VOD LN Equity	VODAFONE GROUP PLC	Telecommunications	33,655
11/11/2026	ABN NA Equity	ABN AMRO BANK NV-CVA	Financials	33,869
11/11/2026	ENR GY Equity	SIEMENS ENERGY AG	Energy	105,055
11/11/2026	EOAN GY Equity	E.ON SE	Utilities	50,066
11/11/2026	RWE GY Equity	RWE AG	Utilities	44,771
11/11/2026	SRG IM Equity	SNAM SPA	Energy	21,012
11/11/2026	VWS DC Equity	VESTAS WIND SYSTEMS A/S	Energy	27,054
11/12/2026	ALV GY Equity	ALLIANZ SE-REG	Financials	174,688
11/12/2026	ENEL IM Equity	ENEL SPA	Utilities	96,186
11/12/2026	III LN Equity	3I GROUP PLC	Financials	32,206
11/12/2026	KBC BB Equity	KBC GROUP NV	Financials	48,783
11/12/2026	MRK GY Equity	MERCK KGAA	Health Care	65,543
11/12/2026	MUV2 GY Equity	MUENCHENER RUECKVER AG-REG	Financials	74,024
11/12/2026	PST IM Equity	POSTE ITALIANE SPA	Financials	40,093
11/12/2026	SIE GY Equity	SIEMENS AG-REG	Industrials	216,575
11/13/2026	ACS SQ Equity	ACS ACTIVIDADES CONS Y SERV	Industrials	24,274
11/13/2026	CFR SE Equity	CIE FINANCIERE RICHEMO-A REG	Consumer Discretionary	110,858
11/13/2026	G IM Equity	GENERALI	Financials	67,554
11/13/2026	TLX GY Equity	TALANX AG	Financials	34,603
11/17/2026	IMB LN Equity	IMPERIAL BRANDS PLC	Consumer Staples	26,964
11/18/2026	EXPN LN Equity	EXPERIAN PLC	Industrials	32,629
11/18/2026	SSE LN Equity	SSE PLC	Utilities	38,322
11/24/2026	CPG LN Equity	COMPASS GROUP PLC	Consumer Discretionary	51,985
11/25/2026	PRX NA Equity	PROSUS NV	Technology	81,128
12/2/2026	ITX SQ Equity	INDUSTRIA DE DISENO TEXTIL	Consumer Discretionary	184,069

Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research 11/05/2026

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Appendix 1

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